APOLLO RESEARCH

Founding Staff, DC Office, (Science Communications, Engagement and Policy Research)

APPLY FOR THIS JOB

Washington DC
Governance / Full-Time / On-Site

About Apollo Research

Apollo Research is a mission-driven startup committed to reducing the threats from scheming frontier AI systems. We work with and are trusted by every frontier AI lab. We do fundamental research, test their models before deployment, and collaborate with them on scheming mitigations. The Governance team conducts research and provides advice on the institutional, legal and strategic implications of AI scheming and loss of control threats, working closely alongside our Science of Scheming, Evaluations, and Monitoring teams.

The Governance team works on a bet: that the national security interventions the U.S. government enacts and implements over the next 15 months, through legislation, procurement and verifiable procedures for testing, monitoring, controlling and pacing frontier AI, will be among the most significant contributions to our collective ability to stay in control of increasingly advanced AI systems.

That means our DC work focuses on identifying, describing and offering policy solutions to some of the hardest open problems at the intersection of AI misalignment and national security: loss of control, evaluation-aware models that stand to undermine existing assessment regimes, and the handoff of the development of AI systems to AIs themselves. We are routinely requested to brief decision makers in the U.S. government's executive and legislative branch and across multiple intelligence agencies, as well as to provide input into relevant federal and state legislation and procurement efforts. The majority of our work is non-public, including privately held demonstrations and briefing materials written for decision makers across key nodes.

Our public facing output includes Assurance of Frontier AI Built for National Security, a roadmap for DoW, ODNI, NIST and CAISI to operationalize AI model reliability and governability through scheming and control evaluations within existing T&E pipelines and OT authority; Misaligned AI as a New Insider Risk, which shows how AI models with authorized access to IL5–IL7 environments and cleared personnel should be treated according to existing insider threat programs; The Need for Deeper, White-Box Access, on why deeper access is required to keep pace with technological progress for verifiable assurance; multiple comments on RFIs, including a comment to NIST's RFI on AI agent security; a Lawfare op-ed on keeping AI testing defense-worthy; and an analysis of NDAA provisions most likely to accelerate AI security.

About this posting. This is a posting primarily intended for mid-career policy wonks interested in joining the Governance team and founding our DC office, though we are open to considering more junior applicants should they be an especially good fit for the role.

We are hiring for individuals to fill roles across **three key areas** and will consider applications for each area. Please kindly indicate your interest for the relevant role in the application form. We are also keen to hear from folks who have a mixture of relevant skills and experience across the profiles described below, in which case we recommend applying to more than one role by ticking the relevant boxes in the application form.

Three roles available:

Founding Staff: Policy and Science Communications Expert

- Communicate Apollo's work and the state of AI progress, safety and security accurately and appropriately to decision makers across the USG and the intelligence community
- Proactively plan communication schedules around Apollo's technical work and releases to brief relevant audiences and decisionmakers
- Prepare relevant presentation material, demonstrations and act as point person to review policy submissions and briefings prepared by colleagues
- Brief and support senior leadership ahead of exchanges and meetings with relevant audiences and decisionmakers
- Contribute to the development and execution of our strategic vision to ensure safe and secure AI development and deployment in accordance with Apollo Research's mission and the organisation's core priorities

Requirements

- Have previously worked in a science communications heavy role with the U.S. Government, ideally communicating complex technological topics to a broad range of stakeholders at pace
- Are a strong and accurate communicator who is skilled at breaking down complex topics into accessible and implementable proposals relevant to your interlocutor
- Have previously developed policy communications packages and prepared senior colleagues for high stakes environments
- Are based in *or willing to relocate* to Washington DC
- Align with Apollo Research's mission and values

Founding Staff: Relationship Management Expert

- Proactively seek out and build foundational relationships with individuals, groups and organisations relevant to Apollo Research's mission
- Manage pre-existing and new relationships with policymakers to generate opportunities for regular engagement and increase understanding of topics relevant to Apollo Research's work
- Convene and brief diverse stakeholders, including through hosting or attending relevant policy events such as requested meeting, discussion panels, or workshops
- Brief and support senior leadership ahead of exchanges and meetings with relevant audiences and decisionmakers
- Contribute to the development and execution of our strategic vision to ensure safe and secure AI development and deployment in accordance with Apollo Research's mission and the organisation's core priorities

Requirements

- Are a verifiably trusted and reliable operator with a wide-reaching DC network across AI relevant groups in the U.S. government and across the intelligence community
- Have previously acquired and managed high stakes relationships and expanded an organisation's contact portfolio while maintaining high integrity
- Deeply understand political and personal dynamics across relevant stakeholder groups and enjoy navigating and bringing them together around shared topics of interest
- Are based in *or willing to relocate* to Washington DC
- Align with Apollo Research's mission and values

Founding Staff: Policy and Legal Research Expert

- Build systems to keep on top of and engage with relevant bills and acts, governance discussions, as well as federal and state-level policy proposals
- Identify the most relevant policy movements and spearhead appropriate strategies to develop novel proposals or to support existing proposals aligned with Apollo's mission
- Work with colleagues to develop timely and accurate policy submissions, responses to requests for information, and policy memos
- Brief and support senior leadership ahead of exchanges and meetings with relevant audiences and decisionmakers
- Contribute to the development and execution of our strategic vision to ensure safe and secure AI development and deployment in accordance with Apollo Research's mission and the organisation's core priorities

Requirements

- Have a robust and up to date understanding of decision-making across the intelligence community, the legislative and executive branches
- Have previously contributed to the drafting of relevant legislation or other policy frameworks or led the drafting of such
- Have successfully seen a policy proposal through to implementation and execution
- Are based in *or willing to relocate* to Washington DC
- Align with Apollo Research's mission and values

You will be an ideal candidate for our DC office if you

- Believe that technological progress from AI will require significant and systemic shifts to ensure a safe and secure transition to significantly more advanced AI systems
- Enjoy a fast paced, entrepreneurial environment with opportunity to swing for the fences while benefitting from mentorship and robust management
- Are detail-oriented with experience working in AI-governance relevant parts of the U.S. government and on relevant areas
- Are excited about delving into the details of existing frameworks as much as thinking through and dreaming up new ways in which U.S. government intervention could be particularly effective and meaningfully positive
- Hold a Masters degree or Ph.D in a related field

Logistics

- Start Date: Target of 2 months after the first interview.
- Time Allocation: Full-time
- Location: D.C., with at least 25% of your time expected to be spent on travelling for relevant meetings, conferences and to work from our London office.

Benefits

- We aim to pay competitive salaries for each role. We expect a salary band of 200,000 - 300,000 USD, commensurate with experience.
- Candidates with exceptional qualifications may be eligible for higher compensation, such as those with more than a decade of experience in the intelligence community, those with validated and repeated experience drafting relevant legislation and seeing them through to success, or those with significant and trusted professional relationships relevant to our mission.
- Flexible work hours and schedule
- Unlimited vacation
- Unlimited sick leave
- Lunch, dinner, and snacks are provided for all employees on workdays
- Paid work trips, including staff retreats, business trips, and relevant conferences
- A yearly $1,000 (USD) professional development budget

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